6. Instruct the patient to avoid daytime naps.
7. Avoid talking about stressful events before bedtime.
8. Avoid excessive physical exertion 3 hours before bedtime.
9. Heavy meals should be avoided 2-3 hours before bedtime.
10. Spicy foods should be avoided before bedtime.
11. Use of loose-fitting night clothes.
12. Slow and deep breathing techniques for few minutes can alleviate tension and induce calmness.
13. Yoga, imagery and medication can also promote sleep.
14. Medication is the last resort to induce sleep.

Highlight

Over time, a lack of sleep can place a person at higher risk for heart problems, diabetes, weight gain and obesity, and Alzheimer's disease. In addition to physical effects, a lack of rest and



particularly Rapid Eye Movement (REM sleep) has also been shown to impair decision making, reaction times, mood, motivation, learning and may also affect memory.

DO YOU KNOW?

You spend **one third** of your life on your bed sleeping. For example, if a person life span is 60 years, then the person would have slept for 20 years.

4.11 MOVING, SHIFTING AND LIFTING PATIENTS.

4.11.1 Introduction

As nurses, we may have to move and lift patients. An important point nurses have to bear in mind while moving patients is that they must observe correct body mechanic for the patients as well as for themselves.

While lifting heavy objects, it is wise to stand with your feet wide apart and firmly on the floor. The weight should be lifted close to the body. Flex your knees so that the strong muscles of the legs bear the weight of the object.

4.11.2 Purposes:

1. To perform the task efficiently.
2. To avoid the patient from unnecessary effort.
3. It prevents nurses from strain and back injuries.
4. To promote circulation and muscular tone.

4.11.3 General Considerations Prior to Action:

- Know the weight of the patient and consider the mode of transportation.
- Know your own limitations and be realistic. If the patient cannot be safely moved. Get help.

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